

Israa Hashem

CONTACT INFORMATION

Department of Economics, Concordia University
1455 de Maisonneuve Blvd. West
Montréal, QC H3G 1M8, Canada

Email: israa.hashem@mail.concordia.ca

Website: israahashem.github.io

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics , Concordia University	2027 (expected)
Dissertation: <i>Essays in Education Economics and Market Design</i>	
Supervisors: Szilvia Pápai and Gabrielle Vasey	
Parental leave: May 2024 – Dec 2024; May 2025 – Aug 2025	
M.A. in Applied Economics (High Distinction), Lebanese American University	2018 – 2020
B.Sc. in Mathematics (Distinction), Lebanese American University	2014 – 2018
Teaching Diploma , Lebanese American University	2017 – 2018

RESEARCH FIELDS

Primary: Economics of Education, Labor Economics, Applied Microeconomics
Secondary: Market Design, Microeconomic Theory, Environmental Economics

REFERENCES

Szilvia Pápai Department of Economics Concordia University szilviapapai@gmail.com	Gabrielle Vasey Department of Economics Concordia University gabrielle.vasey@concordia.ca	TBA
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JOB MARKET PAPER

Sibling Gender and Skill Transmission: Older Sisters and Second-Born Achievement in British Columbia

Children spend much of their time with siblings, yet how siblings affect achievement is far less studied than the role of parents, schools and peers. This paper asks whether the sex of an older sibling matters for how second-born children perform in school. I use administrative records for students enrolled in British Columbia schools, linked to the Census through a child-parent key, and I use this key file to identify siblings as children who share the same parents. Assuming first-born sex is randomly assigned, I first study its effect on second-born children's Foundation Skills Assessment (FSA) scores in Grades 4 and 7, across the three subjects of the exam: reading, writing and numeracy. I find that the advantage of an older sister operates through literacy. Grade 4 FSA reading scores rise by 2.4 percent of a standard deviation and writing scores by 1.5 percent, while numeracy is unaffected. The estimates for Grade 7 are roughly similar. I then study whether first-born sex affects parents' decision to enroll their second-born in French immersion programs. Having an older sister raises participation by around 1.5 and 1.8 percentage points in Grades 4 and 7 respectively. The sex of the first-born therefore matters to some extent both for what

children learn and for how parents invest in their schooling. Finally, I observe that second-borns score below their first-born siblings in all three subjects and in both grades, so having an older sister appears to compensate for part of this birth-order penalty.

WORKING PAPERS

Transmission of Educational Outcomes: A Comparison Between Immigrant and Native Families in Canada

This paper examines how educational mobility and field-of-study preferences differ across Canadian immigrant and non-immigrant families. Using data from the Survey of Labour and Income Dynamics, I document intergenerational persistence in degree attainment and show that this persistence is weaker among children of immigrant fathers, indicating higher educational mobility for second-generation immigrants on the paternal side. I also find strong sorting into STEM fields among first-generation immigrants that does not persist in the second generation, with substantial convergence in degree choice between second-generation immigrants and the native-born population.

Pareto-Efficient Matching with Gradual Acceptances

with Szilvia Pápai

We introduce and analyze the class of Gradual Acceptance (GA) matching rules within the context of one-sided matching with priorities. GA rules extend the Immediate Acceptance rule through a step-wise selection process, slowing down the matching to allow previously rejected applicants to apply to their next highest-ranked schools before these schools are assigned. We show that all GA rules are Pareto-efficient and satisfy basic stability and incentive properties. We also identify a subclass of Secure GA rules with especially good stability and incentive properties, revealing that stability and incentives can be jointly improved using simple selection algorithms while maintaining full efficiency.

PUBLICATIONS

Polluting Resource Extraction and Climate Risk (with Walid Marrouch). *Natural Resource Modeling*, 2023, 36(1), e12354. [doi:10.1111/nrm.12354](https://doi.org/10.1111/nrm.12354)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Course Instructor, Concordia University

ECON 302: Intermediate Microeconomic Theory II

Winter 2027 (Upcoming)

ECON 301: Intermediate Microeconomic Theory I

Winter 2026

Teaching Assistant, Concordia University

ECON 421: Econometrics (tutorials)

Fall 2026

ECON 301: Intermediate Microeconomic Theory I

Summer 2026

ECON 302: Intermediate Microeconomic Theory II

Fall 2025

ECON 440: Economic Design

Fall 2025, Winter 2025, Fall 2022

ECON 326: Mathematics for Economists

Winter 2025, Fall 2023

ECON 695: Economic Design (Graduate)

Winter 2025, Winter 2022

ECON 491: Advanced Environmental Economics

Winter 2024

ECON 425: Advanced Mathematics for Economists

Winter 2023

ECON 437: Economics of Public Expenditure

Winter 2023

ECON 464: Game Theory

Summer 2022

ECON 201: Introduction to Microeconomics

Fall 2020 – Fall 2021

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant to Gabrielle Vasey, Concordia University	2025
Research Assistant, UN-ESCWA (Economic and Social Commission for Western Asia)	2019 – 2020
Research Assistant, Lebanese American University	2018 – 2020

CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

Social Choice and Welfare Conference, Tokyo	2026
20th CIREQ-CIRANO Ph.D. Students' Conference, Montréal	2026
CIREQ Interdisciplinary PhD Conference in Applied Market Design, Montréal	2026
Emergence Excellence Conference	2025
Concordia Graduate Student Seminar	2025

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

FRQSC Doctoral Scholarship, Fonds de Recherche du Québec – Société et Culture	2024 – 2026
FAS Graduate Fellowship, Concordia University	2020 – 2024
International Tuition Award of Excellence, Concordia University	2020 – 2024
Merit Scholarship, Concordia University	2020 – 2021
US MEPI Tomorrow's Leaders Graduate Scholarship	2018
Spirit of Service Award, Lebanese American University	2016
USAID University Scholarship Program (Full Scholarship)	2014

PROFESSIONAL TRAINING

Econometric Society Summer School in Dynamic Structural Econometrics: Market Design	2023
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SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Software:	Stata, R
Data:	Statistics Canada Research Data Centre (RDC); linked administrative data
Languages:	Arabic (native), English (fluent), French (beginner)